

CHINA, COMMUNISM AND ASIA

CHINA'S STATE-COLLAPSE CHAIN → COMPETING POLITICAL ROUTES → MAO'S RURAL STRATEGY → LONG MARCH MECHANISM → WHY THE CCP WON → MAO-ERA BALANCE SHEET

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g3 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00 CHINA'S STATE-COLLAPSE CHAIN

CHINA'S STATE-COLLAPSE CHAIN

FOREIGN PRESSURE

QING LEGITIMACY ERODES

DYNASTY FALLS

YUAN SHIKAI

REPUBLIC BECOMES MILITARY DICTATORSHIP

CENTRAL AUTHORITY FRAGMENTS

MUST REMEMBER

FOREIGN PRESSURE → Qing legitimacy erodes

1911 → dynasty falls

YUAN SHIKAI → republic becomes military dictatorship

WARLORDS → central authority fragments

MUST REMEMBER: Qing crisis, 1911 revolution, warlordism, CCP foundation (1921), KMT rupture

CORE CLAIM

- FOREIGN PRESSURE → Qing legitimacy erodes
- 1911 → dynasty falls

MECHANISM

- YUAN SHIKAI → republic becomes military dictatorship
- WARLORDS → central authority fragments

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- MUST REMEMBER: Qing crisis, 1911 revolution, warlordism, CCP foundation (1921), KMT rupture
- (1927), Long March, Japanese invasion, 1949 victory, Maoist campaigns and post-1978 reform form distinct state-building phases.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: (1927), Long March, Japanese invasion, 1949 victory, Maoist campaigns and post-1978 reform form distinct state-building phases.

01

STAGE 01 COMPETING POLITICAL ROUTES

COMPETING POLITICAL ROUTES

SUN YAT-SEN

NATIONALISM, DEMOCRACY AND LIVELIHOOD

REPUBLICAN-NATIONAL STATE PROJECT

CCP 1921

COMMUNIST ORGANISATION

ALLIANCE BREAKS INTO CIVIL WAR

CORE CLAIM

SUN YAT-SEN → nationalism, democracy and livelihood
KMT → republican-national state project

MECHANISM

CCP 1921 → communist organisation
1927 → alliance breaks into civil war

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- SUN YAT-SEN → nationalism, democracy and livelihood
- KMT → republican-national state project
- SUN YAT-SEN → nationalism, democracy and livelihood
- KMT → republican-national state project

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CCP 1921 → communist organisation; 1927 → alliance breaks into civil war.

02

STAGE 02 MAO'S RURAL STRATEGY

MAO'S RURAL STRATEGY

SMALL URBAN PROLETARIAT

ORTHODOX ROUTE WEAK

MASS RURAL CONSTITUENCY

LAND REFORM

MATERIAL POLITICAL CLAIM

LOCAL GOVERNING LEGITIMACY

SMALL URBAN PROLETARIAT → orthodox route weak

PEASANTS → mass rural constituency

LAND REFORM → material political claim

DISCIPLINE → local governing legitimacy

CORE CLAIM

- SMALL URBAN PROLETARIAT → orthodox route weak
- PEASANTS → mass rural constituency

MECHANISM

- LAND REFORM → material political claim
- DISCIPLINE → local governing legitimacy

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- SMALL URBAN PROLETARIAT → orthodox route weak
- PEASANTS → mass rural constituency

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LAND REFORM → material political claim; DISCIPLINE → local governing legitimacy.

03

STAGE 03 LONG MARCH MECHANISM

LONG MARCH MECHANISM

COMMUNIST RETREAT

LEADERSHIP PRESERVED

DOMINANCE CONSOLIDATED

RETREAT CONVERTED INTO LEGITIMACY

1934-35 → communist retreat

SURVIVAL → leadership preserved

MAO → dominance consolidated

MEMORY → retreat converted into legitimacy

CORE CLAIM

- 1934-35 → communist retreat
- SURVIVAL → leadership preserved

MECHANISM

- MAO → dominance consolidated
- MEMORY → retreat converted into legitimacy

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- 1934-35 → communist retreat
- SURVIVAL → leadership preserved

03

• SMALL URBAN PROLETARIAT → orthodox route weak

• PEASANTS → mass rural constituency

• LAND REFORM → material political claim

• DISCIPLINE → local governing legitimacy

• SMALL URBAN PROLETARIAT → orthodox route weak

• PEASANTS → mass rural constituency

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LAND REFORM → material political claim; DISCIPLINE → local governing legitimacy.

03

STAGE 03

LONG MARCH MECHANISM

LONG MARCH MECHANISM

COMMUNIST RETREAT

LEADERSHIP PRESERVED

DOMINANCE CONSOLIDATED

RETREAT CONVERTED INTO LEGITIMACY

1934-35 → communist retreat

SURVIVAL → leadership preserved

MAO → dominance consolidated

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CORE CLAIM

- 1934-35 → communist retreat
- SURVIVAL → leadership preserved

MECHANISM

- MAO → dominance consolidated
- MEMORY → retreat converted into legitimacy

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- 1934-35 → communist retreat
- SURVIVAL → leadership preserved

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: MAO → dominance consolidated; MEMORY → retreat converted into legitimacy.

04

STAGE 04

WHY THE CCP WON

WHY THE CCP WON

CORRUPTION, INFLATION AND POOR ADMINISTRATION

DISCIPLINE, LAND REFORM AND PEASANT CONTACT

JAPANESE WAR

KMT BURDEN RISES

MAO PROCLAIMS PRC; CHIANG RETREATS

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
KMT → corruption, inflation and poor administration	JAPANESE WAR → KMT burden rises	KMT → corruption, inflation and poor administration
CCP → discipline, land reform and peasant contact	1949 → Mao proclaims PRC; Chiang retreats	CCP → discipline, land reform and peasant contact

CORE CLAIM

- KMT → corruption, inflation and poor administration
- CCP → discipline, land reform and peasant contact

MECHANISM

- JAPANESE WAR → KMT burden rises
- 1949 → Mao proclaims PRC; Chiang retreats

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- KMT → corruption, inflation and poor administration
- CCP → discipline, land reform and peasant contact

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CCP → discipline, land reform and peasant contact.

05

STAGE 05

MAO-ERA BALANCE SHEET

MAO-ERA BALANCE SHEET

UNITY AND LANDLORD POWER WEAKENED

HUNDRED FLOWERS

CRITICISM FOLLOWED BY REPRESSION

GREAT LEAP

COMMUNES, DISRUPTION AND FAMINE

CULTURAL REVOLUTION

EDUCATION AND ADMINISTRATION DAMAGED

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
CONSOLIDATION → unity and landlord power weakened	GREAT LEAP → communes, disruption and famine	CONSOLIDATION → unity and landlord power weakened
HUNDRED FLOWERS → criticism followed by repression	CULTURAL REVOLUTION → education and administration damaged	HUNDRED FLOWERS → criticism followed by repression

CORE CLAIM

- CONSOLIDATION → unity and landlord power weakened
- HUNDRED FLOWERS → criticism followed by repression

MECHANISM

- GREAT LEAP → communes, disruption and famine
- CULTURAL REVOLUTION → education and administration damaged

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- CONSOLIDATION → unity and landlord power weakened
- HUNDRED FLOWERS → criticism followed by repression

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: GREAT LEAP → communes, disruption and famine; CULTURAL REVOLUTION → education and administration damaged.

06

STAGE 06

GREAT LEAP MECHANISM

GREAT LEAP MECHANISM

CRASH TARGETS

ADMINISTRATIVE PRESSURE RISES

RURAL PRODUCTION REORGANISED

FEEDBACK FAILS

ERROR TRAVELS UPWARD

SEVERE DISRUPTION AND FAMINE

CRASH TARGETS → administrative pressure rises

COMMUNES → rural production reorganised

FEEDBACK FAILS → error travels upward

RESULT → severe disruption and famine

CORE CLAIM

- CRASH TARGETS → administrative pressure rises
- COMMUNES → rural production reorganised

MECHANISM

- FEEDBACK FAILS → error travels upward
- RESULT → severe disruption and famine

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- CRASH TARGETS → administrative pressure rises
- COMMUNES → rural production reorganised

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: FEEDBACK FAILS → error travels upward; RESULT → severe disruption and famine.

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ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: GREAT LEAP → communes, disruption and famine; CULTURAL REVOLUTION → education and administration damaged.

06

STAGE 06 GREAT LEAP MECHANISM

GREAT LEAP MECHANISM

CRASH TARGETS

ADMINISTRATIVE PRESSURE RISES

RURAL PRODUCTION REORGANISED

FEEDBACK FAILS

ERROR TRAVELS UPWARD

SEVERE DISRUPTION AND FAMINE

CRASH TARGETS → administrative pressure rises

COMMUNES → rural production reorganised

FEEDBACK FAILS → error travels upward

RESULT → severe disruption and famine

CORE CLAIM

- CRASH TARGETS → administrative pressure rises
- COMMUNES → rural production reorganised

MECHANISM

- FEEDBACK FAILS → error travels upward
- RESULT → severe disruption and famine

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- CRASH TARGETS → administrative pressure rises
- COMMUNES → rural production reorganised

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: FEEDBACK FAILS → error travels upward; RESULT → severe disruption and famine.

07

STAGE 07 CULTURAL REVOLUTION MECHANISM

CULTURAL REVOLUTION MECHANISM

MASS CAMPAIGN

ALLEGED ENEMIES ATTACKED

CONTINUITY BROKEN

AUTHORITY DESTABILISED

SOCIAL ORDER

PROLONGED DAMAGE, 1966-76

MASS CAMPAIGN → alleged enemies attacked

EDUCATION → continuity broken

ADMINISTRATION → authority destabilised

SOCIAL ORDER → prolonged damage, 1966-76

CORE CLAIM

- MASS CAMPAIGN → alleged enemies attacked
- EDUCATION → continuity broken

MECHANISM

- ADMINISTRATION → authority destabilised
- SOCIAL ORDER → prolonged damage, 1966-76

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- MASS CAMPAIGN → alleged enemies attacked
- EDUCATION → continuity broken

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: ADMINISTRATION → authority destabilised; SOCIAL ORDER → prolonged damage, 1966-76.

08

STAGE 08 DENG'S REFORM BOUNDARY

DENG'S REFORM BOUNDARY

DECOLLECTIVISATION AND MARKET MECHANISMS

INVESTMENT AND OPENING

ONE-PARTY RULE RETAINED

FORCE BLOCKS POLITICAL LIBERALISATION

CORE CLAIM

ECONOMY → decollectivisation and market mechanisms
EXTERNAL → investment and opening

MECHANISM

POLITICS → one-party rule retained
1989 → force blocks political liberalisation

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

ECONOMY → decollectivisation and market mechanisms
EXTERNAL → investment and opening

CORE CLAIM

- ECONOMY → decollectivisation and market mechanisms
- EXTERNAL → investment and opening

MECHANISM

- POLITICS → one-party rule retained
- 1989 → force blocks political liberalisation

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- ECONOMY → decollectivisation and market mechanisms
- EXTERNAL → investment and opening

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: POLITICS → one-party rule retained; 1989 → force blocks political liberalisation.

09

STAGE 09 ASIAN COMMUNIST DIVERSITY

ASIAN COMMUNIST DIVERSITY

NORTH KOREA

DIVISION AND EXTREME CENTRALISATION

ANTI-COLONIAL NATIONALISM PLUS COMMUNISM

KHMER ROUGE EXTREMISM

DURABLE ONE-PARTY PRAGMATIC ADJUSTMENT

CLOSE DISTINCTION

THE KMT'S INFLATION, CORRUPTION AND WAR BURDEN MUST BE

CORE CLAIM

NORTH KOREA → division and extreme centralisation
VIETNAM → anti-colonial nationalism plus communism

MECHANISM

CAMBODIA → Khmer Rouge extremism
LAOS → durable one-party pragmatic adjustment

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

CLOSE DISTINCTION: The KMT's inflation, corruption and war burden must be compared with CCP land, discipline, peasant and national-defence strategies
Soviet assistance is not a complete explanation.

CORE CLAIM

- NORTH KOREA → division and extreme centralisation
- VIETNAM → anti-colonial nationalism plus communism

MECHANISM

- CAMBODIA → Khmer Rouge extremism
- LAOS → durable one-party pragmatic adjustment

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- CLOSE DISTINCTION: The KMT's inflation, corruption and war burden must be compared with CCP land, discipline, peasant and national-defence strategies
- Soviet assistance is not a complete explanation.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE DISTINCTION: The KMT's inflation, corruption and war burden must be compared with CCP land, discipline, peasant and national-defence strategies; Soviet assistance is not a complete explanation.

09

STAGE 09 ASIAN COMMUNIST DIVERSITY

ASIAN COMMUNIST DIVERSITY NORTH KOREA DIVISION AND EXTREME CENTRALISATION ANTI-COLONIAL NATIONALISM PLUS COMMUNISM KHMER ROUGE EXTREMISM DURABLE ONE-PARTY PRAGMATIC ADJUSTMENT CLOSE DISTINCTION THE KMT'S INFLATION, CORRUPTION AND WAR BURDEN MUST BE

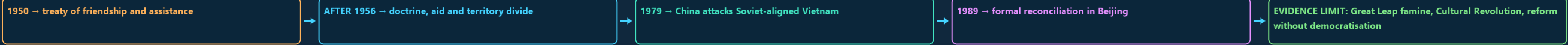
CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
NORTH KOREA → division and extreme centralisation	CAMBODIA → Khmer Rouge extremism	CLOSE DISTINCTION: The KMT's inflation, corruption and war burden must be compared with CCP land, discipline, peasant and national-defence strategies
VIETNAM → anti-colonial nationalism plus communism	LAOS → durable one-party pragmatic adjustment	Soviet assistance is not a complete explanation.
CORE CLAIM - NORTH KOREA → division and extreme centralisation - VIETNAM → anti-colonial nationalism plus communism	MECHANISM - CAMBODIA → Khmer Rouge extremism - LAOS → durable one-party pragmatic adjustment	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT - CLOSE DISTINCTION: The KMT's inflation, corruption and war burden must be compared with CCP land, discipline, peasant and national-defence strategies - Soviet assistance is not a complete explanation.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE DISTINCTION: The KMT's inflation, corruption and war burden must be compared with CCP land, discipline, peasant and national-defence strategies; Soviet assistance is not a complete explanation.

10

STAGE 10 SINO-SOVIET SPLIT

SINO-SOVIET SPLIT TREATY OF FRIENDSHIP AND ASSISTANCE AFTER 1956 DOCTRINE, AID AND TERRITORY DIVIDE CHINA ATTACKS SOVIET-ALIGNED VIETNAM FORMAL RECONCILIATION IN BEIJING EVIDENCE LIMIT GREAT LEAP FAMINE, CULTURAL REVOLUTION, REFORM WITHOUT DEMOCRATISATION



CORE CLAIM 1950 → treaty of friendship and assistance - AFTER 1956 → doctrine, aid and territory divide	MECHANISM 1979 → China attacks Soviet-aligned Vietnam 1989 → formal reconciliation in Beijing	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT - EVIDENCE LIMIT: Great Leap famine, Cultural Revolution, reform without democratisation, - Sino-Soviet rupture and diverse Asian communist routes prevent a triumphalist or monolithic communist-bloc account.
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ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Sino-Soviet rupture and diverse Asian communist routes prevent a triumphalist or monolithic communist-bloc account.

11

STAGE 11 CHINA ANSWER SPINE

CHINA ANSWER SPINE DYNASTY FALLS WITHOUT A FUNCTIONING STATE RURAL ORGANISATION OUT-GOVERNS KMT UNITY PLUS SELF-GENERATED CATASTROPHE MARKETS WITHOUT DEMOCRACY; BLOC FRACTURES



CORE CLAIM - CRISIS → dynasty falls without a functioning state - VICTORY → rural organisation out-governs KMT	MECHANISM - MAO → unity plus self-generated catastrophe - REFORM → markets without democracy; bloc fractures	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT - CRISIS → dynasty falls without a functioning state - VICTORY → rural organisation out-governs KMT
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ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CRISIS → dynasty falls without a functioning state.

E

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT LOWE ARGUES IN EFFECT THAT MAO GAVE CHINA UNITY BUT AT A HUGE HUMAN AND INSTITUTIONAL COST WHEN DENG ALLOWED MARKET INCENTIVES, FOREIGN INVESTMENT AND AGRICULTURAL DECOLLECTIVIZATION. ECONOMIC PRAGMATISM REPLACED PERMANENT MASS CAMPAIGN POLITICS. YET THE COMMUNIST PARTY REMAINED THE UNQUESTIONED POLITICAL CENTRE. TIANANMEN IN 1989 PROVED THAT ECONOMIC OPENING DID NOT THIS IS A CLASSIC UPSC CONTRAST

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH - CAUTION: Lowe argues in effect that Mao gave China unity, independence and revolutionary purpose, - but at a huge human and institutional cost when campaigns displaced administrative rationality. - Deng allowed market incentives, foreign investment and agricultural decollectivization. - Economic pragmatism replaced permanent mass campaign politics.	ADVANCED DEBATE - Yet the Communist Party remained the unquestioned political centre. - Tiananmen in 1989 proved that economic opening did not mean acceptance of organized political opposition. - CAUTION: This is a classic UPSC contrast: marketization inside a one-party Leninist shell . - Communist victory in China transformed the balance of power in Asia.	LEGACY / NUANCE - CAUTION: For India, the relevant sequence is: 1949 PRC - 1954 Panchsheel - 1962 border war - long-term strategic caution . - CAUTION: Do not re-narrate India's China policy here; cross-link it. 20-23 October 2025: the official communique of the CCP's Fourth Plenary Session said the meeting adopted recommendations for - the Fifteenth Five-Year Plan and continued to frame policy around high-quality development, technological capacity and centralized Party leadership.
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OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.